YIELD LIMIT LINE

an original screenplay by
The Omni-Compass LLC

From the published record of Omni-Compass. Every number spoken in it has its receipt (docs/film/production.json, checked by tools/film.py).

The Omni-Compass LLC 4 November 2026
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The characters, Cape Shore Regional Medical Center, the vendor Perihelion and Hurricane Lucinda are fictional. The places are real: Palm Bay, Melbourne, the Indian River Lagoon, US 192, Titusville and Cocoa Beach, on Florida's Space Coast. Omni-Compass is real, and is shown as it works: on top of the controllers a system already runs, never in their place.

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FADE IN:

1 **EXT. PALM BAY, FLORIDA - NIGHT** 1

Rain bands rake a street of low concrete-block houses. Hurricane shutters bolted tight. A stop sign shivers on its post.

One window glows phone-blue.

2 **INT. DEL'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 2

A ceiling fan turns over a woman asleep on top of the covers in yesterday's clothes: DELPHINE "DEL" ARCENEAUX (34), Haitian-American, close-cropped natural hair, a hospital lanyard still around her neck.

On the nightstand, face up: a phone. Beside it, a small dog-bone of steel, stretched thin at the waist and snapped in two.

The phone BUZZES.

Del is sitting up before the second buzz, the way soldiers and new mothers wake.

INSERT - PHONE SCREEN

3:12 AM. PAGE. imaging-api: 95th percentile over 500 ms. Cape Shore Regional.

BACK TO SCENE

She doesn't check the time. She knows the time.

DEL
(to the ceiling)
Three twelve.

She flips open a laptop on the bed. Its glow finds a wall calendar: fourteen months of pages, each one crowded with small red circles drawn at the same hour.

Graphs bloom on the screen. A line climbs, crosses a dotted red line, and keeps climbing.

DEL (CONT'D)
Come on. Come on, come on...

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The line crests. Falls back under the red. Her shoulders drop an inch.

She does not lie down. She sits in the blue light, listening to the wind, waiting for the next one.

SMASH CUT TO:

YIELD LIMIT LINE

3 **EXT. RAY'S HOUSE - MELBOURNE, FLORIDA - DAY** 3

A tidy stucco house under a fast grey sky. Plywood leans against the carport. The garage door is up. A radio talks to nobody.

RADIO (V.O.)
...Hurricane Lucinda, a Category 3, is forecast to stay offshore but bring tropical-storm-force winds to the Space Coast after dark. Brevard County shelters open at noon...

4 **INT. RAY'S GARAGE WORKSHOP - CONTINUOUS** 4

A machinist's chapel. Pegboard walls, every tool outlined in marker so its absence shows. A framed photo: a young man in coveralls, a launch tower behind him.

That man, forty years on: RAYMOND "RAY" ARCENEAUX (69), Haitian-born, white stubble, reading glasses on a cord. He holds a sheet of plywood to a window frame. Del holds the other end, a drill in her free hand, eyes half shut.

RAY
You're holding it crooked.

DEL
I'm holding it fine.

RAY
You're holding it like a woman who slept two hours.

DEL
Three.

He takes the drill from her and sinks four screws without looking. Then he looks.

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RAY
Same time?

DEL
Same time.

RAY
Every night?

DEL
Most nights. Fourteen months.

RAY
And they pay you to find out why.

DEL
They pay me to make it stop.
Finding out why is extra.

Ray crosses to his bench and pulls a dust cover off a small benchtop TENSILE TESTER: a hand crank, two steel jaws, a round dial gauge with a single black needle. He clamps a fresh steel coupon between the jaws.

RAY
Come here.

DEL
Papa. I've seen it.

RAY
You've seen it. Come look.

She comes. He cranks. The jaws pull. The needle climbs, smooth and steady.

RAY (CONT'D)
Every piece of steel has a line. Up to the line, you can load her all day. Let go...

He backs off the crank. The needle sinks to zero.

RAY (CONT'D)
...and she springs back like nothing happened.

He cranks again. The needle climbs, climbs, and HESITATES: a small stutter. Then it moves on.

RAY (CONT'D)
There. You see it? That's the yield. One hair past that...

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He lets go. The needle settles, but not at zero. A little above it.

RAY (CONT'D)
...and she remembers. Forever.

DEL
And past that?

He cranks. The coupon's waist narrows like pulled taffy. There is no sound in the garage but the ratchet.

SNAP.

The halves jump in the jaws. Ray drops them in her palm. They're warm.

RAY
Past that, she don't remember nothing.

Del looks down at the two pieces. She knows this lesson. She has its twin on her nightstand.

RAY (CONT'D)
Pitit mwen. You been ringing past your line a long time.

DEL
Somebody has to hold it.

RAY
Thirty-one years, every part that went up off that pad crossed a bench like this one. Not one was held together by a man's hands. Every piece carried its own load, to its own line. All of them at once. That's what flies.

DEL
My system's not a rocket.

RAY
No. On a rocket, somebody watches all the pieces at once.

She pockets the broken halves.

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5 **INT. CAPE SHORE REGIONAL MEDICAL CENTER - THEO'S OFFICE - DAY** 5

Glass walls. Beyond them the Indian River Lagoon turns to pewter under the storm. Below, crews tape windows in big white Xs.

THEO VANCE (46), Vice President of Infrastructure, Air Force posture in a hospital fleece, stands by a wall screen. SLOANE MERCER (38), immaculate, tablet in hand, is finishing a pitch. Del leans in the doorway with a coffee.

The wall screen, in clean enormous type: PERIHELION. 52% FASTER. 30% OFF YOUR BILL. ZERO BABYSITTING.

SLOANE
...which is why our agent doesn't advise your autoscaler. It replaces it. One brain, no committee. And your engineers finally sleep.

She smiles at Del. Del does not smile back.

THEO
Del. You've had the other one on trial a week. The compass thing.

DEL
Omni-Compass.

THEO
What's its number?

DEL
It doesn't have one yet. It's watching.

SLOANE
(kindly)
Watching.

DEL
It sits on top of what we already run. It doesn't throw anything out. Our autoscaler stays. The cluster stays. It moves them together, every piece to its own limit and never past it. And if it's ever wrong, one switch hands everything back the way it was.

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SLOANE
And how much faster is that?

DEL
I'll tell you when I have a receipt.

SLOANE
We have benchmarks.

DEL
Can I run them?

SLOANE
They're proprietary.

A beat. Theo rubs his eyes.

THEO
The outpatient centers close at nine for the storm. They'll push every scan they've got to us before they lock up. And the board meets at seven tomorrow morning, storm or no storm. They want a number. A big one. With a dollar sign in front.

DEL
And if the true one's small?

THEO
Then bring me a small true one, and I'll lose with it. But bring me something.

6 **INT. CAPE SHORE REGIONAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - DUSK** 6

Stretchers line a corridor. Sandbags at the ambulance bay. Monitors chirp.

NADIA REYES (52), charge nurse, reading glasses pushed up into her hair, wipes down a wall-mounted tracking board. She spots Del passing and aims a pen at her.

NADIA
You. Three-twelve.

DEL
Hi, Nadia.

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NADIA
Your voice is the last thing I hear before my coffee. Two nights ago the CT viewer froze four minutes. Stroke alert on the table. Four minutes, mija.

DEL
I know. I was on the phone with you.

NADIA
I know you know. I'm telling you so you remember it tonight.

She taps the tracking board: rows of patients, and beside each a small shape. Green circles. One yellow diamond.

NADIA (CONT'D)
Green, good. Yellow, coming. Red, I pray in two languages.

DEL
Tonight it's gonna be all of them.

NADIA
Then don't sleep.

DEL
When have I ever.

7 **EXT. COLOCATION DATA CENTER - MELBOURNE - NIGHT** 7

Wind hammers a windowless concrete box. Rain sheets through its floodlights.

8 **INT. COLOCATION DATA HALL - CONTINUOUS** 8

A cold aisle of server racks, ten thousand tiny lights breathing in rhythm. Del walks it with a flashlight past a sign: GENERATOR TESTED 22:00.

At the operations desk, a wall of monitors: THE WALL. Each screen is one muscle of the system: PODS. MACHINES. COOLING. POWER. In each corner, a light. All green circles.

One screen stands apart: OMNI-COMPASS. WATCHING.

Del sits. She drags fourteen months of logs onto the wall. Night stacks on night like strata in a cliff.

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With a grease pencil, she draws a line on the glass at 3:00. Another at 3:05. At 3:09. At 3:12.

DEL
(to herself)
Three o'clock, the clinics send the day's scans. Three-oh-five, the autoscaler notices. Late. It asks for pods. The pods wait. There's no room. Three-oh-nine, the cluster asks for a machine. Three-twelve...

She taps 3:12.

DEL (CONT'D)
...me.

She scrolls on. 3:40, a machine removed. 3:52, pods evicted. 4:10, another small climb.

DEL (CONT'D)
And then they put it all back like it never happened. Every night.

A process list. One name recurs at three o'clock: PRHL-AGENT.

DEL (CONT'D)
Hello.

She opens it. Installed: last Tuesday.

She glances at her phone's calendar. Fourteen months of red circles. The agent is one week old.

DEL (CONT'D)
Not you. You're new.

She sits back and studies the wall. Every light green. Every muscle doing exactly its job.

DEL (CONT'D)
Nobody's wrong. Every one of you does what you were built to do. Alone. And late.

RAY (V.O.)
On a rocket, somebody watches all the pieces at once.

DEL
Yeah. Me. At three-twelve.

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Every rack light in the hall goes dark.

Silence. A heartbeat. Two.

Then a deep diesel THRUM rises through the floor. The lights breathe back.

On the wall: UTILITY POWER LOST. ON GENERATOR. POWER LINE 70%.

DEL (CONT'D)
Okay. Okay.

Her phone buzzes. Not 3:12. It's 1:58.

INSERT - PHONE SCREEN

NADIA: Trauma inbound. Rollover on 192. CT in ten.

BACK TO SCENE

The PODS light turns: a yellow diamond.

A new panel slides onto the wall: PERIHELION AGENT. COST MODE ON. MACHINES 9 TO 6.

DEL (CONT'D)
No. No, no, no. What are you doing?

She opens the agent's panel. It explains itself in a friendly font: Generator budget detected. Parking idle capacity. Projected savings 31%.

DEL (CONT'D)
They're not idle. They're about to work.

The MACHINES light turns to a red octagon. Then PODS. Red octagon.

9 **INT. CAPE SHORE REGIONAL - CT ROOM - CONTINUOUS** 9

The scanner hums. CT technologist DION PRICE (26) stares at a viewer: a spinning wheel. Nadia at his shoulder. On the table, a young man in a cervical collar, rain still on his face.

DION
It's not loading.

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NADIA
(into her phone)
Del.

INTERCUT - DATA HALL / CT ROOM

DEL
I see it.

NADIA
Then fix it.

DEL
Their agent turned off our autoscaler. It didn't sit on top of it. It sat in its chair. And now it's saving money.

NADIA
Tell it to spend some!

On Del's screen, a switch drawn like a red guarded toggle: KILL SWITCH. PERIHELION AGENT.

She flips the guard and throws it.

AGENT STOPPED. NATIVE CONTROLLERS RESTORED.

The native autoscaler wakes. The PODS panel asks for more. The pods wait. Machines begin to boot. Slowly.

DION
Still spinning.

DEL
We're back to normal. Normal is late.

Her eyes go to the one screen that has been patient all night: OMNI-COMPASS. WATCHING.

She takes Ray's broken halves out of her pocket and sets them on the desk.

One week of trial. No receipt. A Category 3 outside.

NADIA
(through the phone)
Del!

Del switches it. WATCHING becomes AUTOPILOT.

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10 **ON THE WALL** 10

Each muscle's screen becomes a gauge: one needle, one line. The generator's 70% is drawn as a hard edge.

The needles rise. PODS. MACHINES. COOLING. POWER. Each toward its own line.

Each needle reaches its line. And holds. Not one hair past.

The lights turn. Red octagon to yellow diamond. Yellow diamond to green circle. One by one.

DEL
(barely a whisper)
Every piece to its own line.

11 **INT. CT ROOM - CONTINUOUS** 11

The wheel stops. An image fills the viewer: the young man's spine, clean and whole.

DION
We're up.

NADIA
(into the phone, breathing again)
We're up.

12 **INT. COLOCATION DATA HALL - LATER** 12

The wall clock reads 4:40. On every screen, green circles. Del's phone BUZZES.

She tenses. Reads.

INSERT - PHONE SCREEN

PAGE. node-14: disk failing.

BACK TO SCENE

She almost laughs.

DEL
That one's real.

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She takes a flashlight and a replacement drive and walks into the cold aisle to do her job.

13 **EXT. INDIAN RIVER LAGOON - CAUSEWAY - DAWN** 13

The storm has gone north. A scrubbed pink sky. Palm fronds strewn across the causeway. Utility linemen ride bucket trucks up to the wires. A line of brown pelicans skims the flat water.

14 **INT. DEL'S CAR - PARKED ON THE CAUSEWAY - CONTINUOUS** 14

A laptop balanced on the steering wheel. On it, a grid of video tiles: the board. Theo in his office. Sloane in a hotel room. GLORIA HAYWOOD (74), retired structures engineer, in a Titusville kitchen while a roof tarp snaps outside her window. Three more members, coffee in hand.

THEO (ON SCREEN)
Two trials, one night. Sloane.

SLOANE (ON SCREEN)
Overnight, on generator power, our agent cut compute cost thirty-one percent. That's the number.

GLORIA (ON SCREEN)
Between what hours?

SLOANE (ON SCREEN)
Between about one and four.

Theo lifts a printout.

THEO (ON SCREEN)
Emergency department log. CT viewer unavailable from one fifty-eight to two sixteen. Trauma patient on the table.

Silence on the call. Sloane's face doesn't move.

SLOANE (ON SCREEN)
Our agent responded to the budget it was given. And hers ran more machines than ours. It burned more fuel.

DEL
It did. That's power given. It bought a scan.

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GLORIA (ON SCREEN)
Cheap is easy at two in the morning. Cheap with nobody hurt is the job.

THEO (ON SCREEN)
Del. Your number.

Del's phone lights on the dashboard: a slide from Theo's analyst. OMNI-COMPASS: 44% FASTER. In small print beneath: our model.

She looks at it for a long second. Deletes it.

DEL
I've got one number, and it isn't from last night.

THEO (ON SCREEN)
Go.

DEL
Last night was one night. One night is a story. Their record is thirteen Kubernetes tests, each one run three times. Count the pages a person would have been sent. Native: thirteen point eight. With it on top: ten point three. A quarter fewer. In all three runs. Every row of it has a receipt, and every receipt has a run number.

SLOANE (ON SCREEN)
And the bill?

DEL
Inside the noise. Nobody's measured your bill. If anybody tells you they did in one night, ask them for the receipt.

GLORIA (ON SCREEN)
(a small smile)
At the Cape we didn't fly on one test.

DEL
Three runs is a receipt.

Beat. Theo looks from tile to tile.

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THEO (ON SCREEN)
Sloane. Can we run your benchmark?

SLOANE (ON SCREEN)
I can send you a summary.

THEO (ON SCREEN)
That's a no.

GLORIA (ON SCREEN)
I move we extend the compass trial ninety days. And Ms. Arceneaux brings us the next receipt.

THEO (ON SCREEN)
Second?

Hands rise in the tiles. Some still holding coffee.

The tiles blink out one by one until two remain. Del. Sloane.

SLOANE (ON SCREEN)
Off the record. How do you sleep, doing it your way?

DEL
Ask me tomorrow.

Sloane almost smiles. Her tile goes dark.

15 **INT. RAY'S GARAGE WORKSHOP - MORNING** 15

Ray pushes an inch of rainwater out under the door with a squeegee. The plywood held. The radio murmurs.

Del comes in, keys in hand, eyes red.

RAY
Well?

DEL
Ninety days.

RAY
That's a yes.

DEL
That's a "bring us the next receipt."

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RAY
That's the only yes there is.

She crosses to the tensile tester. Takes a fresh coupon from the drawer and clamps it in. Ray leans on the squeegee and watches.

She cranks. The needle climbs. Climbs. Hesitates: the yield.

She stops. Backs the crank off.

The needle sinks to zero.

DEL
Springs back.

RAY
You found your line.

She lays the broken halves on the bench beside the whole one. Then she lies down on the old couch along the wall, boots still on.

RAY (CONT'D)
(soft)
Dòmi, pitit.

Her phone BUZZES on her chest. Her whole body flinches.

INSERT - PHONE SCREEN

NADIA: a photo of the emergency department's tracking board, every shape a green circle. One word under it: sleep.

BACK TO SCENE

Del smiles. She turns the phone face down on her chest and closes her eyes.

The radio says the sun is out over Cocoa Beach. Ray lays a blanket over her and goes back to the water.

FADE OUT.

The pages a person would be sent: down 25.7%, GAIN in all three of our runs.

Thirteen Kubernetes tests, real software on GitHub's machines, omni-v21. Receipt: results/OVERSIGHT_PAGES.md.

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The characters, the hospital, the vendor and the storm are fictional. Omni-Compass is real, and every number it speaks here has its receipt.

THE END

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